BY ORDER OF THE SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE INSTRUCTION 36-2688

23 OCTOBER 2026

Personnel

COMMUNITY COLLEGE OF THE AIR FORCE

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

ACCESSIBILITY: Publications and forms are available on the e-Publishing website at www.e-Publishing.af.mil for downloading or ordering

RELEASABILITY: There are no releasability restrictions on this publication

---

OPR: AF/A1D | Certified by: SAF/MR

Supersedes: DAFI36-2688, 3 November 2022 | Pages: 37

This publication implements Department of the Air Force Policy Directive (DAFPD) 36-26, *Total Force Development and Management*. It is consistent with Title 10 United States Code (USC) § 9415, *the Community College of the Air Force: associate degrees*, and § 9417, *Degree granting authority for Air University.* It is also consistent with Department of War (DoW), and Department of the Air Force (DAF) directives for the administration of the 1954 federal policy on accreditation of federally chartered degree-granting institutions. This publication applies to DAF civilian employees and uniformed members of the Regular Air Force (RegAF), United States Space Force (USSF) (sustained and non-sustained), the Air Force Reserve (AFR), and the Air National Guard (ANG). In collaboration with the Deputy Chief of Staff for Manpower, Personnel, and Services (AF/A1), the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital (SF/S1), the Chief of Air Force Reserve (AF/RE), and the Director of the Air National Guard (NGB/CF), DAF develops the personnel guidance for Total Force Development. This instruction requires the collection and or maintenance of information protected by the Privacy Act of 1974 authorized by Department of Defense Directive (DoDD) 5400.11, *DoD Privacy and Civil Liberties Programs*. The applicable System Of Record Notices (SORN) The applicable system of records notices (SORNs) DoD-0020, *Military Human Resource Records*; DoD–0008, *Freedom of Information Act and Privacy Act Records* (FOIA/PA Records); DoD–0005, *Defense Training Records*; F036 AF A1 A, *Air Force Automated Education Management System,* F036 AETC M, *Air University Academic Records*, and F036 AETC L, *Community College of the Air Force Student Transcript, Administration, and Records System* are available at: **http://dpcld.defense.gov/Privacy/SORNs.aspx** This publication may be supplemented at any level, but all supplements must be routed to the Office of Primary Responsibility listed above for coordination prior to certification and approval. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility

listed above using DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*, route DAF Forms 847 from the field through the appropriate chain of command. The authorities to waive wing/unit level requirements in this publication are identified with a Tier ("T-0, T-1, T-2, T-3") number following the compliance statement. See DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures,* Table A10.1 for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate Tier waiver approval authority, or alternately, to the publication office of primary responsibility (OPR) for non-tiered compliance items. The use, in this publication, of any non-Federal entity name, logo, trademark, commercial product or service, or training, certification and accreditation standards, does not constitute endorsement of the DoD of the DAF. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document has been revised and should be completely reviewed. Changes include aligning Community College of the Air Force with Air University's governance and accreditation framework, strengthening affiliated school and instructor standards, clarify degree and student processes, and expanding oversight of academic and credentialing programs.

Chapter 1—OVERVIEW **5**

1.1. Background. 5

1.2. Purpose. 5

1.3. CCAF Mission. 5

1.4. CCAF Vision. 5

1.5. Organizational Structure. 5

Chapter 2—ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES **6**

2.1. Department of Air Force, Voluntary Education Branch Chief (AF/A1DLV). 6

2.2. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital, Force Development (SF/S1D). 6

2.3. Senior Air Force Leaders. 6

2.4. Air Force Personnel Center (AFPC). 6

2.5. Commander, Air Education and Training Command (AETC/CC). 6

2.6. Air Education and Training Command (AETC/A3). 6

2.7. Space Training and Readiness Command (STARCOM) 6

2.8. Commander and President, Air University (AU/CC). 7

2.9. AU Provost and Chief Academic Officer (AU/CAO). 7

2.10. AU Academic Affairs (AU/OAA). 7
2.11. AU Registrar (AU/A7). 7
2.12. Commander, Curtis E. LeMay Center for Doctrine Development and Education (LeMay Center/CC). 7
2.13. Commander and Commandant, Air Force Global College (AFGC/CC). 7
2.14. Commander and Commandant, CCAF (CCAF/CC). 7
2.15. Dean, CCAF (CCAF/DE). 7
2.16. Associate Dean of Academics, CCAF (CCAF/DEA). 8
2.17. Degree Program Managers (DPM). 8
2.18. CCAF Student, Advisor, Faculty, and Educational Relations (CCAF/SAFER). 8
2.19. Education Services Flight (CCAF/DES). 8
2.20. Campus Affiliations/Affiliate School Managers (CCAF/DESOC). 8
2.21. Affiliated Schools. 8
2.22. Credentialing Program Managers (CCAF/DEAL). 9
2.23. CCAF Policy Council. 9
2.24. Career Field Managers (CFM). 9
2.25. Education and Training Section (E&TS). 9
2.26. CCAF Advisors. 10

Chapter 3—ACCREDITIATION 11

3.1. Institutional Accreditation. 11
3.2. Specialized Accreditation. 11
3.3. CCAF Program Parameters. 11

Chapter 4—AFFILIATION 12

4.1. Affiliated Schools. 12
4.2. Policy Requirements 12
4.3. Site Visits. 13
4.4. Affiliation Status. 13
4.5. Campus Affiliations/Affiliate School Managers (CCAF/DESOC). 14
4.6. Affiliate School Commander/Commandant. 14
4.7. Affiliate School Liaison (ASL). 15
4.8. Affiliate School Registrar 15

Chapter 5—INSTRUCTORS 16

5.1. Instructor Qualifications. 16

Table 5.1. Assignment Categories. 16
5.2. Instructor Categories. 17
5.3. Onboarding Requirements. 17
5.4. Faculty Management System Course Assignment. 18
5.5. Student Instructor Training, Internship, and Evaluation Requirements. 18
5.6. Annual Requirements. 19
5.7. Degree Completion Extensions. 20

Chapter 6—COURSE MANAGEMENT AND EVALUATION 21
6.1. Curriculum Development. 21
6.2. Affiliated School Actions. 21
6.3. Course Evaluation. 21
6.4. Degree Program Managers (DPM). 22

Chapter 7—EDUCATION SERVICES 23
7.1. CCAF Education Services Flight. 23
7.2. Education and Training Support. 23
7.3. CCAF Advisors. 23

Chapter 8—CCAF ASSOCIATE OF APPLIED SCIENCE DEGREE PROGRAMS 25
8.1. Enrollment. 25
8.2. Degree Requirements. 25
8.3. Academic Credit. 26
8.4. Graduation. 26
8.5. Exceptions to Policy (ETP). 27
8.6. No-Fault ETP. 27

Chapter 9—OTHER CCAF ACADEMIC PROGRAMS 29
9.1. General Education Mobile (GEM). 29
9.2. AU Associate to Baccalaureate Cooperative (AU-ABC). 29

Chapter 10—CCAF CERTIFICATE PROGRAMS AND OTHER CREDENTIALS 31
10.1. Certifications and Credentials. 31

Attachment 1—GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION 33

Chapter 1

OVERVIEW

1.1. Background. This publication provides policy on the mission and responsibilities of the Community College of the Air Force (CCAF). It identifies CCAF-related responsibilities of commanders at various levels, describes key roles and functions of various positions at the CCAF, details responsibilities of the education services system to include Total Force base education and training managers, outlines requirements associated with affiliation, program eligibility, and oversight of CCAF-affiliated instructional programs.

1.2. Purpose. The CCAF, under the authority of Air University (AU), administers Associate of Applied Science (AAS) degree programs and related credentialing programs in support of Department of the Air Force (DAF) mission readiness, professional development, and career progression of enlisted personnel. For DAF personnel, AU serves as the official repository for academic and military credit for approved educational programs, a role fulfilled in lieu of the Joint Services Transcript (JST) where applicable.

1.3. CCAF Mission. To elevate the enlisted force by advancing technical and leadership capability across all career fields through degrees, credentials, and related programs to support recruiting, retention, career transition, and mission capability and readiness.

1.4. CCAF Vision. The CCAF strives to be the community college of choice for DAF Service members, providing pathways to higher learning for those called to serve.

1.5. Organizational Structure. The CCAF is a component of AU, which is aligned under the Curtis E. LeMay Center for Doctrine Development and Education Commander and Air Force Global College (AFGC). The command structure ensures that CCAF's academic programs are fully integrated with the broader educational, doctrinal, and leadership development missions of the DAF.

1.5.1. The CCAF provides centralized coordination for worldwide operations by partnering with affiliated schools, off-campus instructional sites, and more than 300 education service offices to support its mission.

1.5.2. Under the authority of Air University (AU), the CCAF administers Associate in Applied Science (AAS) degrees and credentialing programs, serving as the official avenue for documenting academic credits earned through approved courses to enhance Department of the Air Force (DAF) mission readiness, while AU functions as the official repository for these credits in lieu of the Joint Services Transcript (JST) where applicable.

Chapter 2

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1. Department of Air Force, Voluntary Education Branch Chief (AF/A1DLV). Is responsible for implementing DoW and DAF policies for CCAF programs. This role also involves providing program oversight.

2.2. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital, Force Development (SF/S1D). Provides policy, guidance, and advocacy for all matters pertaining to USSF Service members for CCAF programs. SF/S1D will serve as the primary advisor for USSF personnel education matters.

2.3. Senior Air Force Leaders. The Deputy Chief of Staff for Manpower, Personnel, and Services (AF/A1), the Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Reserve Affairs and Airman Readiness (SAF/MRR), and the Chief Master Sergeant of the Air Force (CMSAF), Chief Master Sergeant of the Space Force (CMSSF) are responsible for providing strategic guidance to the AETC/CC regarding the overall direction of the CCAF. Their primary role is to ensure that CCAF's goals, objectives, and educational outcomes remain strictly aligned with broader DAF and DoW force development priorities.

2.4. Air Force Personnel Center (AFPC). Serves as the central authority for formally assigning enlisted personnel to faculty duty at CCAF-affiliated schools. Its primary responsibility is managing the official assignment process for the Department of the Air Force (DAF), encompassing both Airmen and Guardians.

2.4.1. Coordination and Approval. AFPC works in conjunction with Air Force major commands (MAJCOMs), Space Force field commands (FLDCOMs), and other services. AFPC provides the final approval to place both Air Force and Space Force members into these instructional and faculty roles.

2.4.2. Assignment Categories. Air Force Personnel Center Assignments (AFPC/DP2OSS) executes these placements by utilizing standardized classification categories to assign personnel to faculty duty at CCAF-affiliated school locations. (See section 5.1. for assignment category table).

2.5. Commander, Air Education and Training Command (AETC/CC). Responsible for providing direct oversight and issuing policy guidance to the Commander, Air University (AU/CC) with respect to the CCAF.

2.6. Air Education and Training Command (AETC/A3). Acts as the quality control and vetting entity, responsible for ensuring that all eligible enlisted personnel (both volunteer and non-volunteer) meet the strict experiential and educational standards outlined in **paragraph 5.1** before being considered for faculty positions.

2.7. Space Training and Readiness Command (STARCOM) . Is responsible for the execution of education and training for USSF personnel. STARCOM will coordinate efforts with SF/S1D and AF/A1DLV to ensure USSF equities are actively supported in the development and execution of CCAF programs.

2.8. Commander and President, Air University (AU/CC). Serves as the governing authority of the CCAF and officially confers degrees upon CCAF graduates. The AU/CC is responsible for establishing foundational policies that dictate academic programs, accreditation standards, general operations, institutional philosophy, mission, vision, and overall effectiveness.

2.9. AU Provost and Chief Academic Officer (AU/CAO). Acting under delegated authority from the AU/CC, the AU/CAO is responsible for implementing the processes, procedures, and assigned tasks necessary to ensure the quality and demonstrate the efficacy of every AU program, to include CCAF. The AU/CAO oversees AU Academic Affairs to ensure strict compliance across all academic operations, thereby sustaining institutional accountability and mission focus.

2.10. AU Academic Affairs (AU/OAA). Provides organizational leadership for academic governance, analytics, institutional effectiveness, program evaluation, survey administration, faculty relations and development, strategic initiatives, and academic advancement—fostering continuous modernization and enhancement of curriculum, instructional methods, and program development aligned with AU's mission and DoW priorities.

2.11. AU Registrar (AU/A7). The Air University (AU) Registrar serves as the official custodian of academic records for all AU programs, ensuring the accuracy, integrity, and strict protection of student data. Acting as the central authority for all student academic history within AU, the office manages a comprehensive range of administrative services, including student enrollments, academic policy enforcement, and degree verification.

2.11.1. The AU Registrar is the sole issuing authority for official university transcripts for current and former enlisted personnel.

2.11.2. For records of all non-CCAF affiliated courses, personnel must refer to the specific learning management systems identified in DAFMAN 36-2689, *Training Program*. Those eligible for an official AU transcript can initiate the request process online by visiting the at **https://www.airuniversity.af.edu/Registrar/Transcript-Requests/**.

2.12. Commander, Curtis E. LeMay Center for Doctrine Development and Education (LeMay Center/CC). The LeMay Center/CC is responsible for overseeing organizational compliance with all AU policies. Key duties include the assignment of the AFGC Commandant.

2.13. Commander and Commandant, Air Force Global College (AFGC/CC). Assigns the CCAF Commandant responsibility for the administration of the CCAF. Approves and provides adequate resources to the CCAF to effectively sustain mission operations. and the formal delegation of responsibility for the governance and operational management of the CCAF.

2.14. Commander and Commandant, CCAF (CCAF/CC). The authority to ensure CCAF's full compliance with The Commission on Colleges and Universities (CC&U) accreditation standards and its active participation within the civilian higher education community and professional organizations. Acts as the final approval and waiver authority for CCAF policies that impact the DAF and other military services, consistent with DAF and DoW directives.

2.15. Dean, CCAF (CCAF/DE). Serves as CCAF's senior academic representative, advocate, and spokesperson within the DAF, DoW, and civilian academia. The CCAF's subject matter expert and institutional focal point for ensuring compliance with AU's academic policies and the CC&U accreditation standards.

2.15.1. Works collaboratively with CCAF leadership and senior leaders in developing strategic, operational, and tactical plans, programs and policies. These plans and policies establish and institute a comprehensive education program and support services aligned with the CCAF, AU, MAJCOM, FLDCOM, DAF, and DoW objectives for enlisted force development. The purpose is to award academic and workplace credentials and enhance force capabilities and mission readiness.

2.15.2. Develops, determines effectiveness of, modifies, and serves as the approval authority for exception to policy (ETP) requests not otherwise delegated to a tier waiver authority in this instruction or elsewhere.

2.16. Associate Dean of Academics, CCAF (CCAF/DEA). Required to hold an advanced, relevant academic credential or terminal degree. Provides essential academic expertise and oversight for degree programs, ensuring compliance with CCAF, AU, and CC&U accreditation standards. This role involves advising CCAF senior leadership on all academic matters to include all CCAF AAS degrees, overseeing DPMs in curriculum development and program coordination, and serving as a liaison and subject matter expert to career field officials regarding Career Field specialty codes -based degree programs and credentials.

2.17. Degree Program Managers (DPM). The primary academic architects and subject matter experts who are responsible for designing, updating, and evaluating CCAF AAS degree programs for specific Air Force and Space Force specialty codes. They serve as the critical link between military technical training and civilian academic standards, ensuring courses translate to valid college credit and align with evolving career field requirements.

2.18. CCAF Student, Advisor, Faculty, and Educational Relations (CCAF/SAFER). Oversee accreditation compliance across CCAF affiliations and coordinate with CCAF Advisors at Education & Training Sections through two flights, Education Services and Campus Affiliations.

2.19. Education Services Flight (CCAF/DES). The CCAF Education Services Flight and external education and training support agencies work in tandem to ensure Service members receive comprehensive academic guidance, system access, and degree-completion support. Together, they provide the coordinated advisement, resources, and institutional connectivity required to help Service members successfully pursue and complete higher-education goals through CCAF. Additionally, this flight is responsible for managing and delivering the CCAF Advisor Course and administering global access to the Air University Student Information System (AUSIS) for all CCAF Advisors.

2.20. Campus Affiliations/Affiliate School Managers (CCAF/DESOC). Provide critical oversight and guidance for all CCAF-affiliated schools to ensure continuous compliance with CC&U accreditation and affiliation standards. They act as the primary liaison between local schoolhouses and the Academic Review Committee by conducting triennial compliance visits, managing faculty records, and enforcing institutional policies.

2.21. Affiliated Schools. DAF training organizations that partner with CCAF to award collegiate credit by maintaining strict compliance with CC&U accreditation standards and CCAF institutional policies. Under the leadership of the Commander/Commandant, the Affiliate School Liaison (ASL) and Registrar coordinate to manage local academic governance, faculty qualifications, compliance reporting, and strict long-term student record management.

2.22. Credentialing Program Managers (CCAF/DEAL). Responsible for developing, managing, and administering certificate and professional credentialing programs that broaden DAF members' occupational development in coordination with AU Academic Affairs policies. These managers design specialized supporting courses, advise students and global Education and Training Sections (E&TS) on credentialing opportunities, and evaluate national professional credentials for the award of collegiate credit applicable to technical and elective requirements within CCAF degree programs.

2.23. CCAF Policy Council. Chaired by the CCAF Dean (CCAF/DE) and composed of representatives from all elements of the CCAF system, meets annually to review and recommend updates to academic policies, degree programs, credit-award processes, academic standards, school affiliations, and other policy matters. The council submits its recommendations to the CCAF Commandant for review and concurrence. Following review, the CCAF Commandant and Dean elevates the approved policy council items to the AU/CAO and the appropriate AU Advisory Committee for additional guidance and final direction.

2.23.1. Advisory Panels and Committee. The CCAF has two advisory panels and one committee to provide feedback and oversight from faculty, student services, and academic leadership perspectives.

2.23.1.1. Affiliate School Advisory Panel (ASAP). Comprised of representatives from technical, specialized, and professional military education sites. Members review policies, procedures, and affiliation requirements for off-campus instructional locations. This annual panel meeting provides feedback and proposes policy changes.

2.23.1.2. Education Services Advisory Panel (ESAP). Comprised of members from DAF Headquarters, MAJCOMs, FLDCOMs, base-level education services, ANG, and AFR, representing and advocating for the advisors' and students' perspectives in the educational process. This annual panel meeting provides feedback and proposes policy changes.

2.23.1.3. Academic Review Committee (ARC). Promotes effective education and training for the enlisted force, ensures that academic standards reflect the best practices in education, tailored to the unique military environment. The committee is led by the CCAF/DE and includes senior academic and military leadership to guarantee alignment with accreditation standards and academic policies for CCAF programs. It convenes monthly, or more frequently if required, to review academic issues and advise the CCAF Commandant.

2.24. Career Field Managers (CFM). In collaboration with CCAF DPM, ensure the vocationally based degree for the career field accurately reflects high-level strategic priorities and evolving occupational requirements. CFMs also coordinate with DPMs for their participation in career field Utilization and Training Workshops (U&TW) and on Specialty Training Requirements Teams (STRT) to advise other participants on CCAF academic policies and accreditation standards.

2.25. Education and Training Section (E&TS). Responsible for the academic advisement and counseling of CCAF students. The Education and Training Section Chief or a designated representative serves as the primary official in charge of planning and ensuring continuity for local CCAF graduation ceremonies at least once per year, in accordance with DAFI 36-2681, *Voluntary Education Program*.

2.26. CCAF Advisors. Operating within installation E&TS, Reserve E&TS, and ANG Force Development Offices (ANG/FDO), and qualifying 3F2X1 duty positions, CCAF Advisors serve as the primary academic guides for Service members.

Chapter 3

ACCREDITIATION

3.1. Institutional Accreditation. AU operates under institutional accreditation granted by the CC&U. Institutional accreditation applies to the entire university and extends to all AU programs, services, and locations, regardless of delivery method. CC&U accredits institutions as a whole and does not accredit individual programs or courses. AU maintains specialized accreditation, where required, to meet mission needs and DAF requirements.

3.1.1. Regular Evaluation. AU will undergo regular evaluation by CC&U to ensure the quality of its educational programs. **(T-1)** Major areas of review will include academic programs, faculty qualifications, and student success outcomes. As part of the AU system, CCAF and all affiliated schools, courses and programs are subject to this institutional review.

3.1.2. Evaluation Management. AU Academic Affairs oversees the university-wide review process for all CCAF degree programs. To ensure compliance with institutional and specialized accreditation standards, AU Academic Affairs will assess whether programs meet the established outcomes, goals, and continuous improvement requirements. **(T-2)**

3.2. Specialized Accreditation. To enhance program credibility and value, selected CCAF AAS degrees maintain specialized accreditation from civilian agencies, ensuring curriculum quality aligns with established professional and industry standards.

3.3. CCAF Program Parameters. While affiliation with CCAF is voluntary, participating schools and courses must adhere to all AU and CCAF program parameters, academic policies, and standards to ensure compliance and protect AU's accreditation status. **(T-2)**

3.3.1. Curriculum Changes. CCAF encourages schools and career fields to update curriculum content, instructional methods, and course structures to meet evolving mission requirements; however, all changes must be coordinated through CCAF to ensure they remain within the parameters of AU institutional accreditation standards. **(T-2)**

3.3.2. When course or program changes meet the CC&U or AU definition of a substantive change (a physical relocation to a different installation or closure of a degree program), CCAF must coordinate with the relevant career fields or schools to ensure changes are implemented in alignment with sound academic practices and accreditation requirements. **(T-2)**

Chapter 4

AFFILIATION

4.1. Affiliated Schools. Affiliated schools are DAF education or training organizations that voluntarily partner with CCAF to award collegiate credit. These schools operate under the authority and oversight of the accredited institution and must meet all standards established by AU's institutional accrediting body (CC&U) and CCAF. Commanders with authority over affiliated schools, programs, or courses are responsible for ensuring compliance with AU and CCAF policy, guidance, and accreditation responsibilities. **(T-2)** Additionally, affiliated schools may maintain Off-Campus Instructional Sites (OCIS), which are geographically separated from the main campus and offer 50 percent or more of an educational program's instruction. To initiate and maintain affiliation, interested schools must formally accept these responsibilities, comply with all accreditation standards, and contact CCAF's Campus Affiliations office for process requirements. **(T-2)** To maintain affiliation, schools must agree to comply with the following responsibilities:

4.1.1. Formal Appointment. Appoint, in writing, at least one primary and one alternate ASL to serve as the direct link to CCAF. ASLs must attend CCAF provided training within 180 days of appointment. **(T-2)**

4.1.2. Manage Policy. Affiliated schools shall establish and publish local policies regarding academic freedom, academic integrity, non-attribution, and academic student complaints. **(T-2)** All policies must align with DoW and DAF directives. **(T-0)**

4.1.3. Faculty Selection and Documentation. Select and maintain academically and technically qualified instructional faculty. Instructional faculty qualifications must be documented in the CCAF-approved faculty management system. **(T-2)**

4.1.4. Continuous Improvement and Assessment. Affiliated schools shall establish, implement, and document a cycle of continuous improvement to measure academic performance and student achievement. **(T-2)** This includes developing and implementing assessment plans for each course that align with the school's educational mission and student learning outcomes (SLOs); these assessment plans must be submitted in conjunction with course control documents. **(T-2)**

4.1.5. Annual Report. Will provide an annual report to CCAF by 15 December of each calendar year, documenting compliance with affiliation standards and reporting on institutional effectiveness measures. **(T-2)** Affiliated schools will submit assessment plans, results, and evidence of the use of results for improvement as part of the CCAF Annual Report. **(T-2)**

4.1.6. Graduate Reporting. Reports course graduates within 5 days of course completion in the approved student information system. Graduate records must be retained for 30 years and forwarded to the AU Registrar upon school closure or disaffiliation. **(T-0)**

4.2. Policy Requirements . Affiliated schools must establish, publish and enforce local policies. **(T-2)**

4.2.1. Academic Freedom. Affiliated schools will balance the right to explore complex subjects with the need to adhere to the Uniform Code of Military Justice (UCMJ) and professional standards of conduct. **(T-0)**

4.2.2. Academic Integrity. Affiliated schools will manage reports and investigations of academic dishonesty, including plagiarism and unauthorized use of materials or artificial intelligence. **(T-0)**

4.2.3. Student Complaints. Affiliated schools will handle formal written student complaints related to academic matters with resolutions at the lowest appropriate level. **(T-2)**

4.3. Site Visits. To ensure adherence to established standards and offer programmatic assistance, CCAF will conduct various types of on-site assessments. **(T-2)**

4.3.1. Compliance Requirements Visit (CRV). CCAF shall conduct a funded triennial CRV to ensure affiliated schools maintain ongoing compliance with affiliation and accreditation standards. **(T-2)**

4.3.2. Substantive Change Visit. A school-funded visit required for significant modifications, including relocation, command realignment, or major program changes. Schools must provide advance notification to CCAF before implementing any substantive changes. **(T-2)**

4.3.3. Staff Assistance Visit (SAV). A school-funded engagement, initiated at the request of the school to facilitate specialized training, technical assistance, or programmatic guidance.

4.4. Affiliation Status. Affiliation with CCAF is contingent upon a school's sustained compliance with established requirements. Based on ongoing assessments and site visits, CCAF will classify each affiliated school into one of the following status categories to reflect its current standing and dictate any required corrective actions. **(T-2)** CCAF communicates affiliation status directly with the affiliated school.

4.4.1. Good Standing. Affiliated schools are granted good standing upon initial affiliation. This status will be sustained by demonstrating continuous compliance with no significant findings during a CRV. **(T-2)**

4.4.2. Non-Compliant Statuses. CCAF may impose administrative sanctions on affiliated schools that fail to address significant deficiencies or meet established standards. To regain good standing, the institution must develop and execute an approved corrective action plan. **(T-2)** The school is required to host and fund a mandatory, out-of-cycle CRV to validate that all deficiencies have been successfully remediated. **(T-2)**

4.4.2.1. Warning. A public sanction issued when a school fails to meet specific affiliation standards. A school may remain on Warning for a maximum of one year. During this public sanction status, the school must demonstrate substantial progress towards compliance to avoid more severe sanctions. **(T-2)**

4.4.2.2. Probation. This is the most severe administrative sanction issued by CCAF and indicates a significant or persistent failure to adhere to affiliation requirements. This section serves as the final institutional notice prior to the initiation of disaffiliation proceedings.

4.4.3. Discontinuing Affiliation. This action is the formal process that terminates the partnership between CCAF and an affiliated school. It occurs when a school undergoes a mission change, is no longer capable of sustaining affiliation requirements, or fails to maintain CCAF standards. An OCIS may disaffiliate with CCAF by either of two methods, voluntary or involuntary.

4.4.3.1. Involuntary Disaffiliation. Involuntary Disaffiliation has serious consequences since graduates of a disaffiliated site no longer earn CCAF credit. If involuntary disaffiliation is considered, CCAF Campus Affiliations will report issues meeting affiliation requirements to the ARC. **(T-2)** In coordination with the Dean, the CCAF Commandant holds final-approval authority for all disaffiliation actions.

4.4.3.2. Voluntary Disaffiliation. To request voluntary disaffiliation, the affiliated school must execute the following procedures. **(T-2)**

4.4.3.2.1. Initial Consultation. The affiliated school's commander or Commandant shall initiate a formal consultation with the CCAF/CC regarding the intent to disaffiliate from the CCAF. **(T-2)**

4.4.3.2.2. Formal Notification. Following the consultation, the affiliated school's commander must submit a written memorandum for record (MFR) to the CCAF Campus Affiliations office. The MFR must detail the reason for disaffiliation, the proposed effective date, and a comprehensive plan for records disposition. **(T-2)**

4.4.3.2.3. Course Closure Coordination. The ASL or the school's course manager(s) must notify the applicable CCAF course manager(s) in writing, providing the specific course number(s) and the effective date of course closure. **(T-2)**

4.4.3.2.4. Administrative Review. The ARC will review the circumstances and administrative actions surrounding the disaffiliation and report its findings to CCAF leadership **(T-2)**

4.4.3.3. Records Disposition. A disaffiliating school has 14 calendar days after the final graduating class to provide the AU Registrar with electronic records of all graduates for the previous 30 years (or from the date of initial affiliation, whichever is shorter). **(T-0)** Any long-term record retention should be worked with the appropriate record professional on ideal record keeping standards. **(T-2)**

4.4.3.4. Termination of Credit. CCAF will cease awarding academic credit for all courses associated with the disaffiliated school, effective the official date of disaffiliation. **(T-2)**

4.5. Campus Affiliations/Affiliate School Managers (CCAF/DESOC). Will serve as the primary oversight authority for all CCAF-affiliated schools and is responsible for ensuring continuous compliance with CC&U Principles of Accreditation and CCAF affiliation requirements. **(T-2)** Managers will conduct record reviews of schoolhouses utilizing the faculty management system of record and execute Compliance Requirements Visits (CRV) of affiliated schools every three years to assess adherence to affiliation standards. **(T-2)** Furthermore, they will maintain official records of affiliate status, provide operational guidance to affiliated schools, and serve as the official liaison between affiliate schools and the Academic Review Committee (ARC) for all matters requiring review, coordination, or voting. **(T-2)**

4.6. Affiliate School Commander/Commandant. Responsible for ensuring compliance with this publication, promoting a culture of integrity, and providing resources to accomplish the mission. This includes developing local academic policies and maintaining qualified faculty. The site commander/commandant must appoint, at a minimum, one primary, and one alternate ASL. **(T-2)**

4.7. Affiliate School Liaison (ASL). Will serve as the direct link between the school and CCAF. **(T-2)** The ASL will ensure compliance with accreditation standards, maintains faculty documentation, submits the Annual Report, and briefs the school commander quarterly on CCAF matters. **(T-2)**

4.8. Affiliate School Registrar . Responsible for accurately reporting course graduates within 24 hours of course completion, maintaining student records for a minimum of 30 years, and reporting student withdrawals or eliminations. **(T-2)**

Chapter 5

INSTRUCTORS

5.1. Instructor Qualifications. Individuals assigned to faculty duty and teaching CCAF credit-awarding courses will be fully qualified, to include being awarded at least a two-year degree from an accredited institution in the discipline they will teach and with at least one year applied experience in the field/discipline. **(T-2)** Failure to complete degree requirements within the required timeframe or obtain an approved degree completion extension (DCE) will result in the instructor being removed from instructor duties and the instructor record inactivated in the faculty management system. **(T-2)**

5.1.1. Validation Requirements. AETC/A3 acts as the primary quality control and vetting authority for instructor duty. AETC/A3 will validate the academic and professional qualifications of all eligible enlisted personnel (both volunteer and non-volunteer) to ensure they meet the strict experiential and educational standards outlined in this section. **(T-2)** Upon validation, AETC/A3 will coordinate with AFPC for final selection and placement approval to fill authorized instructor duty vacancies. **(T-2)** Guardians in CCAF instructor roles should contact their assignments representative to validate their position requirements.

5.1.2. Candidate Categorization. During the vetting and placement process, AETC/A3 will categorize all eligible candidates to ensure the most qualified personnel are prioritized for instructor vacancies. **(T-2)** Table 5.1 details the specific assignment categories used to classify candidates based on their volunteer status, progression toward an associate degree, and applied experience in the discipline field.

Table 5.1. Assignment Categories.

CATEGORY	DEFINITION
Category 1	Volunteer with a minimum associate degree in the academic discipline and a minimum of one year applied experience in the discipline field
Category 2	Non-volunteer with a minimum associate degree in the academic discipline and a minimum of one year applied experience in the discipline field
Category 3	Volunteer within 12 semester hours of completing an associate degree in the academic discipline and a minimum of one year applied experience in the discipline field
Category 4	Non-volunteer within 12 semester hours of completing an associate degree in the academic discipline and a minimum of one year applied experience in the discipline field

5.1.3. Provisional Instructors. Faculty members who have not completed a two-year degree may be assigned if the member requires no more than 12 semester hours to complete the required associate degree, and the degree is completed within 12 months of the date assigned instructor duty.

5.1.3.1. DAF Instructors. Air Force or Space Force instructors must have been awarded an associate degree prior to pursuing the Instructor of Technology and Military Science (ITMS) degree or a related civilian degree. **(T-2)**

5.1.3.2. Sister Service Instructors. Service members who report not meeting the CCAF residency requirement must pursue the quickest option available: the CCAF ITMS degree or a CCAF Campus Affiliations-approved civilian degree. **(T-2)**

5.1.4. Alternative Qualifications. Instructors may possess specialized technical expertise in career fields where academic degrees are not a primary measure of proficiency. These instructors may be deemed qualified through a portfolio of significant applied experience, professional awards, advanced occupational training, and other recognized certifications.

5.1.5. Exceptional Qualifications. In rare circumstances involving unique or highly technical fields, instructors may be approved to teach as Exceptionally Qualified in Lieu of a Degree (EQILD). The CCAF/DE serves as the approval authority for all such requests and no site will have more than five percent of its total faculty in EQILD status at any time. **(T-2)**

5.2. Instructor Categories. All CCAF-affiliated schools must employ, based on their individual mission needs, a sufficient number of qualified instructors. **(T-2)** Instructors assigned to teach CCAF courses must possess relevant credentials, experience, and training in instructional methods. **(T-2)** To ensure instructional objectives are met, CCAF recognizes three specific categories of instructors: Instructor Candidate (IC), Student Instructor (SI), and Qualified Instructor (I). **Note**: While faculty members can serve as instructors, not all faculty are instructors; the term faculty is not inclusive of all instructor categories.

5.2.1. Instructor Candidate (IC). Newly assigned faculty will be placed in IC status to in-process the site and begin meeting initial faculty requirements. **(T-2)** IC status is temporary and must not exceed six months. **(T-2)**

5.2.2. Student Instructor (SI). Faculty members who have not yet met all requirements for full qualification will be designated as SIs. SIs have 12 months from their Date Assigned Instructor Duty (DAID) date to complete all required training, evaluations, and documentation necessary to achieve qualified instructor status. **(T-2)**

5.2.3. Qualified Instructor (I). Faculty who hold qualified instructor status must have successfully completed all IC and SI requirements, training, evaluations, and documentation, and are officially recognized as qualified CCAF instructors. **(T-2)** A qualified instructor must meet, and be formally confirmed to meet, established standards, including possession of at least a two-year degree in the discipline they teach and a minimum of one year of applied practical experience in their designated field. **(T-2)** If an exception to these standards is granted, the instructor must complete all associated conditions within 12 months. **(T-2)**

5.2.4. Instructor of Record (IOR). The Instructor of Record (IOR) is the qualified instructor responsible for the delivery of course objectives to the student, approving successful student completion of objectives, and resolution of problems arising during instruction. In most cases, the IOR delivers the lesson to the students. When an SI delivers the lesson, the IOR will provide confirmation the objectives were met. **(T-2)**

5.3. Onboarding Requirements. Newly assigned instructors must complete all onboarding requirements within prescribed timelines to ensure their eligibility for advancement toward full instructor qualification. These mandatory requirements include completing in-processing, submitting qualification documentation, finishing instructional methodology training, and establishing both a competency plan and a degree plan (if applicable). **(T-2)**

5.3.1. Reporting. Within 30 calendar days of reporting for instructor duty and entering Instructor IC status, personnel must complete the in-processing checklist and begin fulfilling their initial instructor qualification requirements. **(T-2)**

5.3.2. Instructor Qualification Worksheet (IQW). All IC reporting for duty must complete an IQW during the in-processing phase. This worksheet is required to formally demonstrate and document competence in the specific academic or technical discipline they are assigned to teach. **(T-2)**

5.3.3. Degreed Instructors. Verification of degree will be completed by ASL. The ASL must establish and maintain official documentation, including transcripts, certifications, and records of annual requirement in the CCAF-approved faculty management system. **(T-2)**

5.3.4. Degree Completion Plan (DCP). All non-degreed IC must establish a DCP within 30 calendar days of entering IC status. The DCP serves as a formal roadmap detailing all remaining degree requirements and projected course completion dates. **(T-3)** To remain qualified, instructors are required to monitor their academic progression and continuously update their DCP in the applicable management system. These updates must accurately reflect completed courses and final grades until the degree is officially awarded. **(T-2)** Those who do not hold an associate degree from an accredited institution are eligible for the CCAF Instructor Tuition Assistance Program (CITP).

5.3.5. Date Assigned Instructor Duty (DAID). The DAID will be officially recorded in the faculty management system for all ICs once fully prepared to assume instructional duties, not to exceed the six-month IC timeframe. **(T-2)** The DAID must occur after the instructor has graduated from an approved instructional methodology course. **(T-2)**

5.3.6. Instructional Methodology. All instructors must complete a CCAF-approved instructional methodology course before advancing to SI status. **(T-2)**

5.4. Faculty Management System Course Assignment. To maintain an active instructional status, all fully qualified instructors must be assigned to at least one course within the faculty management system. **(T-2)**

5.5. Student Instructor Training, Internship, and Evaluation Requirements. Instructors must demonstrate subject-matter proficiency and complete a structured 180-hour teaching internship consisting of supervised teaching, curriculum development, qualification tasks, faculty evaluations and professional development within 12 months of their DAID to achieve fully qualified instructor status. **(T-2)**

5.5.1. Subject Matter Testing. Instructors must demonstrate proficiency in every assigned course by successfully completing the required Subject Matter Testing (SMT). SMT verifies technical knowledge and instructional readiness needed for accurate and effective teaching. All SMT must be completed before independent instruction. The SMT may include written exams, performance assessments, oral evaluations or other approved methods. Completion must be documented in the faculty management system as part of the instructor’s qualification record. **(T-2)**

5.5.2. Teaching Internship (180 hours). All CCAF instructors (enlisted, officer, civilian, contractor or foreign military) must complete a 12 semester-hour CCAF-approved teaching internship course within 12 months of DAID. **(T-2)** The teaching portion of the internship must not begin before completion of an instructional methodology course. **(T-2)** Test control procedures, lesson plan development, and audio/visual aids development/preparation or faculty subject matter qualifications may be started before the DAID. Teaching internships are as follows:

5.5.2.1. Supervised Teaching (120 hours). Instructors will receive a minimum of 120 contact hours of supervised teaching in a classroom, aircraft and/or laboratory setting with students. **(T-2)** These hours must be supervised by a qualified CCAF faculty, CCAF faculty supervisor, standards/evaluations, flight chief or other designated personnel qualified to evaluate. **(T-2)**

5.5.2.2. Tracking Progress. All teaching hours must be tracked and documented in the approved faculty management system. **(T-2)** Hours should be documented in no more than two-week increments and no more than 80-hour blocks. **(T-2)** Supervised teaching hours will be documented under the Experience Log tab. **(T-2)**

5.5.2.3. Curriculum and Lesson Plan Development (30 hours). Experience in using a variety of technologies to research, develop curriculum, and plan instruction must be gained. **(T-2)** Emphasis should be placed on matching tools and resources to satisfy instructional needs.

5.5.2.4. Teaching Qualifications (30 hours). Experience (hours) in test administration and review, academic counseling of students, faculty performance feedback and SMT must be recorded in the faculty management system before completion of internship will be recognized. **(T-2)**

5.5.2.5. Faculty Evaluations. An instructor will be evaluated against criteria measuring performance. Student Instructors must pass three faculty evaluations by a qualified faculty. **(T-2)** One of the three evaluations must be completed within 90 days of date assigned to the course and the remaining two evaluations must be completed within 365 days of the DAID. **(T-2)**

5.6. Annual Requirements. To remain qualified, all faculty must complete the following mandatory annual requirements documented in the designated faculty management system. **(T-2)**

5.6.1. Subject Matter Testing (SMT). Instructors must demonstrate sustained technical proficiency and current knowledge for every course they are authorized to instruct. **(T-2)**

5.6.2. Teaching Evaluation. Instructors must undergo a formal, documented evaluation of their instructional delivery. **(T-2)** The assessment, conducted by personnel trained and authorized to evaluate instructor performance, is completed to ensure instructors apply effective teaching methods and techniques. **(T-2)**

5.6.3. Professional Development. Instructors must engage in continuous learning by completing at least one professional development event annually. **(T-3)** This requirement may be satisfied through participation in workshops, academic seminars, military training courses, or continuing education programs directly related to enhancing their specific teaching discipline, technical expertise, or overarching instructional skills.

5.7. Degree Completion Extensions (DCE). ASLs may request up to two DCEs for an instructor (up to three months per extension request and not to exceed a total of six months) to meet their mandatory degree requirements. The CCAF/DE will serve as the sole approval authority for all DCE requests. **(T-2)**

5.7.1. Extension Guidelines. Extensions will only be considered for personnel who are unable to finish their degree, within twelve months of their DAID due to documented, extenuating circumstances. **(T-2)**

5.7.2. **Extension Request Package.** The ASL shall coordinate with CCAF Campus Affiliations prior to submitting a complete extension request package on behalf of the instructor. **(T-2)** Packages must be accurate and submitted no later than 30 days before the one-year anniversary of the instructor's DAID to be actionable. **(T-2)**

Chapter 6

COURSE MANAGEMENT AND EVALUATION

6.1. Curriculum Development. Curriculum is driven by mission requirements and determined by stakeholders in a three-year cycle involving Occupational Analysis, STRT meetings, and U&TW. New or modified curricula identified from these sessions are translated and updated within the affiliated school's course control documents.

6.1.1. Affiliated School Curriculum Team. Will develop the internal course, materials, and Course Control Documents for the CCAF Course Manager(s) to evaluate for credit. **(T-2)**

6.1.2. CCAF Course Manager. Upon receipt of course control documents from the affiliated school(s), the CCAF Course Manager will review and distribute them to the appropriate DPM for evaluation. CCAF Course Manager reserves the right to initiate the re-evaluation of any course or program at any time, based upon CCAF requirements and policies, even if the course underwent no changes. **(T-2)**

6.2. Affiliated School Actions. All proposed actions regarding affiliated schools or courses require formal written notification to CCAF. Advance notification of these events is critical, as they may constitute a substantive change requiring mandatory reporting to CCAF's accrediting body, CC&U. **(T-2)**

6.2.1. New Courses. To ensure compliance with academic standards, new courses and schools must complete established CCAF evaluation and affiliation processes prior to initiation. **(T-2)**

6.2.2. Course Modifications. Any modification to an existing course must be submitted immediately with updated course control documents for formal evaluation. **(T-2)**

6.2.3. Relocation or Closure. Affiliated schools shall notify CCAF Campus Affiliations of any planned relocation or closure of a course, program, or school prior to implementation, as these actions may constitute a substantive change requiring advance reporting under institutional accreditation standards. **(T-2)** Upon notification, the CCAF/DE shall coordinate with AU Academic Affairs to determine if formal notification to the CC&U or an official site visit is required. **(T-2)**

6.3. Course Evaluation. The course evaluation process consists of four distinct steps: submission, intake and triage, evaluation and credit award. Academic credit is awarded in accordance with the credit awarding policy established in Air University instruction and published governance. All course evaluations are conducted by qualified civilian faculty and DPMs within CCAF's Academic Management division. These subject matter experts evaluate proposed courses to determine the appropriate amount of academic credit that course completion will yield.

6.3.1. Course Control Documents (CCD). Course control documents establish the official learning outcomes for courses and programs, providing the essential data required to determine appropriate academic credit awards. To ensure academic integrity and accurate credit application, CCAF must formally review and evaluate these documents for every iteration of an affiliated course. **(T-2)** Affiliated school curriculum teams must submit course control documents to CCAF Course Managers for credit evaluation at least 30 calendar days prior to the course start date. **(T-2)** This deadline applies to all new, revised, or tentative courses, including those in validation or beta test status. **(T-2)**

6.3.2. Document Types. Course control document submissions must consist of two distinct parts. **Part 1** provides the detailed instructional plan which includes Plans of Instruction (POI), Education Plans (typically utilized in medical programs), training appendices, or Syllabi of Instruction (SOI) (e.g., AETC Form 133, *Plan of Instruction/Lesson Plan – Part I*, or an approved equivalent). **Part 2** provides the high-level course overview and standards, which includes Course Charts, Course Training Standards (CCTS), or formal course summaries (e.g., AETC Form 449, *Course Chart*, or an approved equivalent). For approved alternative Course Control Documents, Affiliated Schools will work with qualified civilian faculty and DPMs within CCAF's Academic Management Division based on course category. **(T-3)**

6.3.3. Approved Course Revisions. For existing, approved CCAF courses that undergo revision or modification, the affiliated school curriculum team must submit updated course control documents to the CCAF Course Manager at **ccaf.cd@us.af.mil** for evaluation. **(T-2)** These submissions must include a summary of changes and all superseded course information (e.g., previous course number, course end/inactive dates) to ensure accurate records are maintained in AUSIS. **(T-2)**

6.3.4. Evaluation Timeline. Affiliate schools must submit all required course documents in accordance with established deadlines. **(T-2)** CCAF shall allow up to 14 business days to initiate formal course evaluations. **(T-3)**

6.4. Degree Program Managers (DPM). DPMs will develop and maintain CCAF AAS degree programs for their assigned Air Force specialty codes or Space Force specialty codes **(T-2)** To ensure programs remain current, DPMs will continuously monitor career field changes to identify the need for new degree programs or revisions to existing ones. **(T-2)** Furthermore, DPMs will maintain active communication with career field functional managers, civilian academic institutions, and relevant business and industry leaders to align military training with civilian standards. **(T-2)**

6.4.1. Qualifications and Expertise. DPMs will be selected for their deep functional knowledge and demonstrated career-field proficiency. **(T-2)** DPMs must hold a 7-skill level or its authorized service equivalent, have a minimum of five years of experience in their Primary Air Force specialty codes or Space Force specialty code, and possess a specialty-related CCAF AAS degree. **(T-2)** While not mandatory, it is highly desirable for DPMs to also hold a baccalaureate degree and professional licensure or certification relevant to their specialty. **(T-2)**

6.4.2. Academic and Student Services. DPMs will evaluate DAF technical course curricula to determine potential collegiate credit awards and develop course descriptions comparable to those found at civilian academic institutions. **(T-2)** DPMs will ensure credit is properly mapped and applied to student records while providing expert guidance to CCAF Advisors on academic programs and policies. **(T-2)** Furthermore, DPMs are responsible for completing accurate student record updates and processing graduation nominations in accordance with established academic policies and accreditation standards. **(T-2)**

6.4.3. Career Field Collaboration. DPMs will actively participate in U&TWs and STRTs. **(T-2)** These forums, conducted by the DAF CFM and AETC Training Pipeline Manager, are essential for developing and reviewing the life-cycle performance and training requirements of DAF Specialties, ensuring a direct link between on-the-job training and education.

Chapter 7

EDUCATION SERVICES

7.1. CCAF Education Services Flight . Joint academic support functions, falls to the CCAF Education Services Flight and external education and training support agencies will work in tandem to ensure Service members receive comprehensive academic guidance, system access and degree-completion support. **(T-2)** The Education Services Flight also manages and delivers the CCAF Advisor Course to administer global access to the AUSIS for all CCAF Advisors.

7.1.1. CCAF Advisor Course. CCAF Education Services Flight is responsible for managing and delivering the CCAF Advisor Course **(T-2)**

7.1.2. Quarterly Training. The Education Services Flight will support CCAF Advisors by providing ongoing professional development, updated resources and official publications to ensure Advisors remain current in policies, procedures and best practices. **(T-2)** Training and updates will be communicated through established communication channels and in quarterly virtual professional development sessions. **(T-2)** Sessions that do not include controlled information will be recorded and made available for on-demand viewing. **(T-2)**

7.1.3. Air University Student Information System (AUSIS). CCAF Education Services Flight is responsible for managing global access to the AUSIS for all CCAF Advisors. **(T-2)**

7.2. Education and Training Support. The E&TS's and Force Development Offices (FDO) worldwide provide direct academic advisement and support to Service members pursuing their educational goals. These offices ensure Service members receive accurate guidance, degree-planning assistance, and access to testing and academic resources required for completing an AAS degree through CCAF.

7.2.1. Liaises with the CCAF/DES and coordinates with the CCAF Administrative Center to ensure proper academic advisement, degree processing, and compliance with CCAF policies and procedures.

7.2.2. Testing Support. Provides information and guidance regarding standardized testing programs, such as the College-Level Examination Program (CLEP) and Defense Activity for Non-Traditional Education Support (DANTES) Subject Standardized Tests (DSST), to assist students in earning academic credit through examination.

7.3. CCAF Advisors. This role is filled at the installation level by dedicated CCAF Advisors, Education Services Specialists, and Guidance Counselors located within the local base E&TS or FDO personnel and qualifying 3F2X1 duty positions. CCAF Advisors support Service members as they progress toward completing their AAS degrees. To ensure accurate academic planning and institutional compliance, all advising personnel will strictly adhere to the policies, academic standards, and operational guidance outlined in the AU Academic Catalog, the CCAF General Catalog, and the CCAF Advisor Handbook. **(T-2)**

7.3.1. Mandatory Training. CCAF Advisors must complete the CCAF Advisor Course, conducted by the Education Services Flight (CCAF/DES), within 90 days of appointment. **(T-2)** Training requirements may be fulfilled through resident classes, regional classes, virtual learning platforms, or direct training assistance visits.

7.3.2. Administrative Responsibilities. CCAF Advisors will use the Air Force Automated Education Management System (AFAEMS) to submit CCAF Action Requests (SAR) to process student-related tasks such as updating records, evaluating civilian transcripts for credit, enrolling students into degree programs and initiating degree candidacy nominations. **(T-2)**

Chapter 8

CCAF ASSOCIATE OF APPLIED SCIENCE DEGREE PROGRAMS

8.1. Enrollment. Enlisted DAF Service members are automatically enrolled as students in accordance with their assigned Service specific specialty code during basic military training. A Service member who has separated, retired, or commissioned is no longer eligible to pursue an AAS degree with CCAF. **(T-1)**

8.1.1. Enrollment Changes. In the event a Service member is enrolled in an incorrect AAS degree plan, the applicable CCAF Advisor will submit a change request on behalf of the Service member through AFAEMS. **(T-2)**

8.1.2. Subsequent Degree Enrollment. A Service member may register in a subsequent degree program applicable to their primary, secondary, tertiary, or fourth Service specific specialty code, as reflected in MilPDS. To be eligible for degree conferral, the Service member must continuously maintain all specialty and skill level qualifications required by DAFMAN 36-2100, *Military Classification, Technical Training, and Retraining*, from the point of initial enrollment through the date of graduation. **(T-2)**

8.2. Degree Requirements. CCAF utilizes a 60-credit AAS model to align degree programs with enlisted Air Force and Space Force career fields. Most specialty codes map to specific vocational pathways; alternative degrees are provided for those lacking a specific discipline.

8.2.1. Vocational Degrees. CCAF vocational degrees are designed to prepare Service members for specialized technical roles within and beyond the DAF. These programs award the AAS degree by integrating and formalizing the knowledge gained through technical education; leadership, management, and military studies; general education; and program electives.

8.2.2. Non-Vocational Degrees. For the select specialty codes that do not align with a specific vocational discipline, CCAF provides alternative non-vocational degree pathways. Service members in these career fields are eligible to pursue the Military Technology and Applied Sciences Management (MTASM) or the ITMS degrees, ensuring all personnel have access to an accredited AAS program regardless of their technical categorization.

8.2.2.1. Military Technology & Applied Sciences Management (MTASM). The MTASM degree program provides a pathway to an AAS degree for Airmen and Guardians whose specialty codes lack a dedicated vocational discipline or contain insufficient institutional technical training credits. To ensure equitable access to educational resources, the MTASM degree is restricted to initial degree seekers and cannot be pursued as a secondary or subsequent degree by Service members who already possess a conferred CCAF AAS degree. **(T-2)**

8.2.2.2. Instructor of Military Science & Technology (ITMS). The ITMS program is available to DAF enlisted Service members, sister services, and foreign military services assigned to instructor duties at any CCAF-affiliated instructional site. To ensure professional readiness, candidates must hold a Journeyman (5-level) skill rating or its authorized service equivalent. **(T-2)**

8.3. Academic Credit. An academic credit hour measures the instruction, academic rigor, and learning outcomes required for a degree or credential. Although AU operates outside the traditional semester model within an accelerated warfighter education environment, it strictly applies higher education standards for engagement, learning, and achievement. This ensures AU maintains overall quality, consistency, and academic compliance. Academic credit is awarded in accordance with the credit awarding policy established in Air University instruction and published governance.

8.3.1. Credit Application. CCAF optimizes the application of academic credits toward graduation requirements using a prioritized hierarchy. This hierarchy begins with institutional program credit, followed by upgrade training, recognized professional certifications, and finally, applicable transfer credits from external civilian institutions.

8.3.2. Transfer Credit. To ensure academic integrity and degree relevance, all transfer credits and professional certifications must be formally evaluated by AU and verified by CCAF prior to application. **(T-2)** Service members are responsible for submitting official transcripts from accredited civilian institutions and providing valid credentialing documentation. **(T-2)** These external credits will only be applied to a student's record if they directly align with the specific degree program requirements and meet the minimum academic standards established by AU. **(T-2)**

8.4. Graduation. Service members must complete all academic and technical degree requirements prior to applying for graduation. **(T-2)** The conferral of a CCAF degree is not an automatic process; it is the sole responsibility of the Service member to initiate the action by formally requesting graduation through their local E&TS. **(T-2)** Upon receiving the request, a CCAF Advisor will audit the Service member's academic record, verify that all requirements have been satisfied and submit the official graduation nomination to CCAF for final approval. **(T-2)**

8.4.1. Skill Level Requirement. To be eligible for degree conferral, Service members must be fully qualified and hold at least a journeyman (5-skill level) or authorized service equivalent in the specific Air Force or Space Force specialty code aligned with their degree program. **(T-2)**

8.4.2. Residence Requirement. Service members must complete a minimum academic residence requirement. **(T-2)** At least 25 percent of the total credit hours required for a degree program must be earned through formal, documented instruction delivered by a CCAF-affiliated school or authorized DAF training pipeline. **(T-2)** For a standard 60-credit AAS degree, this equates to a minimum of 15 semester hours of institutional credit. Credits that satisfy the residence requirement typically include Basic Military Training (BMT), initial skills training (technical school), and formal PME. Transfer credits from civilian colleges, credit-by-examination (e.g., CLEP/DANTES Subject Standardized Tests (DSST)), and external professional certifications cannot fulfill the academic residence requirement. **(T-2)**

8.4.3. Separated, Retired, or Commissioned. Service members must satisfy all academic and technical degree requirements prior to their official date of separation (DOS), retirement, or commissioning. **(T-0)** Service members have up to six (6) years from their DOS, retirement, or commissioning appointment to formally file an intent to graduate. **(T-2)** Once separated, retired, or commissioned, they are not eligible to register for, or earn, any subsequent CCAF degrees. **(T-0)**

8.4.4. Wounded Warrior Program. Enlisted Airmen and Guardians registered as a Wounded Warrior due to being seriously wounded, ill, or injured may complete their CCAF AAS degree after leaving service. **(T-0)** A Wounded Warrior who initiated a CCAF AAS degree while on active status but did not complete it may continue their program after separation or retirement if they were awarded a 9W-series reporting identifier for combat- or duty-related injuries or illnesses, as documented in the Military Personnel Data System (MilPDS). **(T-2)**

8.4.4.1. Participation Limitation. Continued participation is strictly limited to the specific degree program in which the Service member was registered at the time of their duty status change. Eligible personnel are granted a maximum of ten years from their official DOS or retirement date to complete all academic requirements and apply for degree conferral. **(T-0)**

8.4.4.2. CCAF Education Services is the designated point of contact for separated or retired Wounded Warriors at **ccaf.edservices@us.af.mil**. **(T-2)**

8.5. Exceptions to Policy (ETP). In the event a DAF Service member is unable to complete all graduation requirements through standard academic pathways, they may request an ETP to enable degree completion. To be considered, the Service member must provide sufficient justification and supporting documentation for the request. **(T-2)** An ETP will only be considered if the exception will result in the Service member graduating. **(T-2)**

8.5.1. CCAF Advisor Coordination. A Service member pursuing an ETP must coordinate with their local base CCAF Advisor. **(T-2)** The CCAF Advisor will submit the ETP to the ARC which must be signed by the Service member. **(T-2)**

8.5.2. ARC Coordination. The ARC examines the submitted ETP and the Service member's academic record to determine and submit a recommendation to the CCAF/DE. The CCAF/DE is the final authority for ETP requests. **(T-2)** To be approved, an ETP must represent an educationally sound action that aligns with accepted academic standards and best practices. **(T-2)**

8.5.3. Eligibility Criteria. Service members may request an ETP only for the degree program they are currently enrolled in. Additionally, they must be qualified to hold and maintain the appropriate specialty and skill level or authorized service equivalent. **(T-2)**

8.5.4. Submission Limitations. ETPs requests will not be granted for the following reasons: the assumption that prior approvals justify a new exception; a deficit of only one or two credit hours for graduation; impending retirement, separation, or commissioning; a lack of awareness regarding specific degree requirements; or the need for a degree to support an Enlisted Performance Report (EPR), promotion, or civilian employment consideration. **(T-2)**

8.6. No-Fault ETP. A No-Fault ETP is a special consideration the CCAF may grant when a Service member's Air Force or Space Force specialty code, special duty identifier (SDI) or reporting identifier (RI) is rescinded for reasons beyond the Service member's control. Qualifying circumstances must include but are not limited to medical disqualification, mandatory retraining, career field mergers or conversions or any situation in which the member loses their specialty through no fault of their own. **(T-2)**

8.6.1. Qualifying Requirements. Service members must be enrolled in the degree program associated with the specialty that was rescinded, be actively pursuing that degree and hold a Journeyman-level (5-skill level or its authorized service equivalent) or higher in that specialty at the time it was removed in order to be considered. **(T-2)**

8.6.2. Timeline. Request must be submitted within one year from the date a Service member's specialty is officially rescinded. **(T-2)** The CCAF/DE serves as the final approval authority for all No-Fault ETP determinations. If the request is approved, all remaining degree requirements must be completed within one year of the ETP approval date. **(T-2)**

8.6.3. Required Documents. Service members shall include the following supporting documentation in their submission: a DAF Form 2096, *Classification/On-the-Job Training Action*, reflecting the specialty, awarded skill level, SDI, or RI held and the official date of removal; medical documentation (when applicable), including a physician's memorandum or diagnosis identifying the disqualifying condition; a commander's memorandum detailing the reason for removal; and a student memorandum formally requesting No-Fault ETP consideration. **(T-2)**

Chapter 9

OTHER CCAF ACADEMIC PROGRAMS

9.1. General Education Mobile (GEM). The GEM program connects Service members pursuing an AAS degree through the CCAF with civilian academic institutions offering online courses that fulfill the CCAF's AAS general education requirements.

9.1.1. Program Management and Compliance. CCAF retains overall administrative responsibility and serves as the final approval authority for the GEM program. **(T-2)** To ensure partners maintain compliance with educational requirements, accreditation standards, and the GEM partnership agreement, CCAF will conduct an annual review of all participating institutions. **(T-2)**

9.1.2. Academic Institution Participation. To participate in the GEM program, academic institutions must comply with the GEM MoU by delivering general education courses via the distance learning format and maintain a current DoW Memorandum of Understanding (MoU). **(T-2)**

9.1.3. Program Guidelines. Upon acceptance as a GEM program partner, academic institutions must submit proposed general education courses to the CCAF undergraduate curriculum manager for formal review. **(T-2)** To maintain program quality, manageability, and balance, each partnering academic institution is limited to a maximum of 10 active GEM-approved courses per General Education category (Written, Oral, Math, Social Sciences, and Humanities), allowing for a maximum of 50 total courses per institution. **(T-2)** GEM program academic institution courses must be accepted as transfer credits into the Air University Associate-to-Baccalaureate Cooperative (AU-ABC) program's degree. **(T-2)**

9.1.4. Maintenance of Program Records. The AU Registrar is responsible for approving all GEM program courses and keeping the official list of those courses in the Civilian Course Conversion Table (CivCCT), which serves as the central, authoritative source for confirming whether a course counts for credit. **(T-2)** Any updates or revisions to previously approved courses will go through a formal review process through the AU Registrar. **(T-2)** The CivCCT will remain accessible to both E&TS personnel and Service members. **(T-2)**

9.2. AU Associate to Baccalaureate Cooperative (AU-ABC). The AU-ABC program connects CCAF AAS graduates with accredited civilian academic institutions that offer baccalaureate-level educational pathways that align with the Service member's occupational specialty code ensuring that the member's military training and CCAF coursework are effectively applied toward a four-year degree.

9.2.1. Program Management and Compliance. CCAF provides overall administrative management for the AU-ABC program. Following academic instructional approval, academic institutions must submit individual applications for each degree program to be reviewed and approved by an appointed CCAF academic officer. **(T-2)** To ensure program quality and manageability, each academic institution is limited to a maximum of 10 active programs. **(T-2)** Academic institutions will undergo a mandatory annual review to ensure continuous compliance with all program requirements. Any subsequent program updates or revisions must undergo the formal CCAF approval process before implementation. **(T-2)**

9.2.2. Academic Institution Participation. To participate in the AU-ABC program, civilian academic institutions must register through the Academic Institution Portal (AI Portal). **(T-0)** Academic institutions are required to provide documented evidence of appropriate academic accreditation and must maintain a current DoW MoU to remain eligible for partnership. **(T-0)**

9.2.3. Maintenance of Program Records. The AI Portal will serve as the official repository for all AU-ABC program records. **(T-1)** AF/A1DLV will maintain this centralized platform to ensure Service members have continuous access to comprehensive program information, including finalized degree plans, participating partner listings and credit applicability. **(T-1)**

Chapter 10

CCAF CERTIFICATE PROGRAMS AND OTHER CREDENTIALS

10.1. Certifications and Credentials. CCAF offers and recognizes a variety of specialized certificates and professional credentials strategically designed to enhance professional development, validate military training against civilian industry standards, and boost overall mission readiness. These credentials serve a dual purpose: to increase a Service member's technical proficiency for current mission requirements while simultaneously preparing them for civilian career opportunities post-service.

10.1.1. Industry Certifications. CCAF may award academic credit for specific industry-recognized credentials including national certifications, state licensures and professional registries to eliminate redundant training and accelerate degree completion. The credential must directly align with the technical requirements of the Service member's current CCAF AAS degree program. **(T-2)** Credential(s) must be active and current at the time of submission, and the Service member must provide official documentation such as primary source verification from the certifying agency for CCAF evaluators to review and apply the appropriate academic credit. **(T-2)**

10.1.2. CCAF Certifications and Credentials. CCAF offers one certificate program and two credential options for eligible Service members.

10.1.2.1. Joint Service Aviation Maintenance Technician Certification Council (JSAMTCC) Airframe & Powerplant (A&P) Program. This program is available to aircraft maintenance Service members in selected specialties, enabling them to apply their military training and on-the-job experience toward a civilian Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) A&P license. Issued in conjunction with the FAA, the JSAMTCC certificate serves as official authorization to take the exam and fully satisfies all FAA pre-exam requirements without additional civilian evaluations.

10.1.2.2. CCAF Instructor Certificate (CIC). The CIC program recognizes the expertise of officers, enlisted, and civilian instructors teaching college-level, credit-awarding courses at CCAF-affiliated schools. This professional credential formally certifies a faculty member's instructor development training, education and practical teaching experience. To be eligible, nominees must be actively teaching and possess a formal recommendation from their school commander. **(T-2)**

10.1.2.3. CCAF Instructional Systems Development (ISD) Program. The CCAF ISD program is a professional credential that formally documents the specialized training, education and practical experience of qualified curriculum developers, course writers and training managers at CCAF-affiliated schools. This credential validates a professional's expertise in the instructional design process. The program ensures military training curriculums are academically rigorous, instructionally sound and meet the high standards required for awarding collegiate credit.

BRIAN L. SCARLETT, SES, DAF
Principal Deputy Assistant Secretary of the
Air Force for Manpower and Reserve Affairs

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

10 USC § 9415, *Community College of the Air Force: associate degrees*

10 USC § 9417, *Degree granting authority for Air University*

DAFPD 36-26, *Total Force Development and Management*, 18 January 2024

DAFI 36-2681, *Voluntary Education Program*, 17 December 2025

DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, 18 October 2023

DAFMAN 36-2689, *Training Program*, 22 January 2024

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Progra*m, 23 March 2020

CC&U *Principles of Accreditation*

AU *Academic Catalog*, current edition

CCAF *General Catalog*, current edition

CCAF *Advisor Handbook*, current edition

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*

DAF Form 2096, *Classification/On-the-Job Training Action*

AETC Form 133, *Plan of Instruction/Lesson Plan – Part I*

AETC Form 449, *Course Chart*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

A&P—Airframe and Powerplant

AAS—Associate of Applied Science

AETC—Air Education and Training Command

AFAEMS—Air Force Automated Education Management System

AFGC—Air Force Global College

AFPC—Air Force Personnel Center

AFR—Air Force Reserve

AI Portal—Academic Institution Portal

ANG—Air National Guard

ARC—Academic Review Committee

ASAP—Affiliate School Advisory Panel

ASL—Affiliate School Liaison

AU—Air University

AU-ABC—Air University Associate to Baccalaureate Cooperative

AUSIS—AU Student Information System

BMT—Basic Military Training

CCAF—Community College of the Air Force

CCD—Course Control Documents

CCTS—Course Training Standards

CC&U—The Commission on Colleges and Universities

CFM—Career Field Manager

CIC—CCAF Instructor Certificate

CITP—Instructor Tuition Assistance Program

CivCCT—Civilian Course Conversion Table

CLEP—College-Level Examination Program

CMSAF—Chief Master Sergeant of the Air Force

CMSSF—Chief Master Sergeant of the Space Force

CRV—Compliance Requirements Visit

DAF—Department of the Air Force

DAFI—Department of the Air Force Instruction

DAFMAN—Department of the Air Force Manual

DAFPD—Department of the Air Force Policy Directive

DAID—Date Assigned Instructor Duty

DANTES—Defense Activity for Non-Traditional Education Support

DAS—Date Arrived Station

DCE—Degree Completion Extension

DCP—Degree Completion Plan

DOS—Date of Separation

DoW—Department of War

DPM—Degree Program Manager

DSST—DANTES Subject Standardized Tests

E&TS—Education and Training Section

EPB—Enlisted Performance Brief

EQILD—Exceptionally Qualified in Lieu of a Degree

ESAP—Education Services Advisory Panel

ETP—Exception to Policy

FAA—Federal Aviation Administration

FDO—Force Development Office

FLDCOM—Field Command

GEM—General Education Mobile

I—Qualified—Instructor

IC—Instructor Candidate

IOR—Instructor of Record

IQW—Instructor Qualification Worksheet

ISD—Instructional Systems Development

ITMS—Instructor of Military Science and Technology

JSAMTCC—Joint Service Aviation Maintenance Technician Certification Council

JST—Joint Service Transcript

MAJCOM—Major Command

MFR—Memorandum for Record

MilPDS—Military Personnel Data System

MoU—Memorandum of Understanding

MTASM—Military Technology and Applied Sciences Management

OCIS—Off Campus Instructional Site

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

PD—Professional Development

PME—Professional Military Education

POI—Plan of Instruction

RegAF—Regular Air Force

RI—Reporting Identifier

SAV—Staff Assistance Visit

SI—Student Instructor

SLO—Student Learning Outcomes

SMT—Subject Matter Testing

SOI—Syllabi of Instruction

SORN—System of Record Notice

STRT—Specialty Training Requirements Team

U&TW—Utilization & Training Workshops

UCMJ—Uniform Code of Military Justice

USC—United States Code

USSF—United States Space Force

Office Symbols

AETC/CC—Commander, Air Education and Training Command

AF/A1—Deputy Chief of Staff for Manpower, Personnel, and Services

AF/A1D—Deputy Chief of Staff for Manpower, Personnel, and Services, Force Development Directorate

AF/A1DLV—Air Force Voluntary Education Programs

AF/RE—Chief of Air Force Reserve

AFPC/DP2OSS—Air Force Personnel Center Assignments

AFGC/CC—Air Force Global College Commander and Commandant

ANG/FDO—Air National Guard Force Development Office

AU/CAO—Air University Provost and Chief Academic Officer

AU/CC—Air University Commander and President

CCAF/CC—Community College of the Air Force Commander and Commandant

CCAF/DE—Community College of the Air Force Dean

CCAF/DES—Education Services Flight

CCAF/SAFER—Community College of the Air Force Student, Advisor, Faculty, and Educational Relations

E&TS—Education and Training Section

LeMay Center/CC—Curtis E. LeMay Center for Doctrine Development and Education Commander

NGB/CF—Director of the Air National Guard

SAF/MRR—Assistant Secretary of the Air Force, Reserve Affairs and Airman Readiness

SF/S1—Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital

SF/S1D—Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital, Force Development

STARCOM—Space Training and Readiness Command

Terms

Certification—The recognition or credential given to an individual who has met predetermined qualifications set by an agency of government, industry, or a profession.

Faculty—Individual whose primary duties directly support the AU educational mission through a triad of responsibilities: teaching, scholarship, and service.

Instructor—Individual focused primarily on the direct delivery and assessment of curriculum/instruction.